

Potty Regression New Sibling — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION TYPE

- ☐ **Identify the Regression Type:** Observe whether your child has occasional accidents without strong emotions, frequent accidents when you're busy with the baby, or genuine distress and withholding behaviors.
- ☐ **Identify the Regression Type:** Track when accidents happen most often to determine if they correlate with divided attention, which indicates an attention-seeking regression.
- ☐ **Identify the Regression Type:** Watch for anxiety signals like new clinginess, sleep disruption, baby talk, or regression in other areas, which signal an anxiety-driven regression.
- ☐ **Identify the Regression Type:** Check for physical symptoms like straining, hard stools, blood in stool, crying during bowel movements, or frequent urination, which require medical attention.

RESPOND BASED ON TYPE

- ☐ **Respond Based on Type:** If your child has a normal developmental regression, clean up accidents neutrally without drama, punishment, or excessive praise and simply move on.
- ☐ **Respond Based on Type:** If your child is seeking attention through accidents, give a brief calm response like 'You had an accident, let's clean it up' with no long conversations.
- ☐ **Respond Based on Type:** For attention-seeking regressions, schedule at least 10 minutes of completely uninterrupted one-on-one time with your older child every single day.
- ☐ **Respond Based on Type:** For anxiety-driven regressions, prioritize connection and physical comfort over potty training pressure and help your child's nervous system settle first.

KNOW WHEN TO GET HELP

- ☐ **Know When to Get Help:** Contact your pediatrician if your child shows signs of constipation or withholding, since chronic constipation makes regression significantly harder to resolve.
 - ☐ **Know When to Get Help:** Seek medical evaluation immediately if you notice straining, blood in stool, crying during bowel movements, or symptoms of a urinary tract infection.
 - ☐ **Know When to Get Help:** Give the regression time to resolve using the appropriate response method, since most regressions pass within 2 to 12 weeks when handled correctly.
 - ☐ **Know When to Get Help:** Trust that this regression is temporary and almost always resolves, so focus on low-pressure response rather than forcing quick results.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.